SAN FRANCISCO BAY UNIVERSITY

# The Newcomers' Guide To SFBU





SFBU





## A practical survival guide for new students

**Navigating campus, Housing, Transportation, Student life, Campus resources**

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# Contents

**Starting university in a new environment can feel overwhelming. This guide shares practical tips and insights to help you navigate your first weeks at SFBU.**


1. Welcome to San Francisco Bay University ..... 3
Introduction to the guide and adjusting to university life.

2. First Day at SFBU ..... 4
What to expect during orientation and setting up your student accounts.

3. Understanding the Campus ..... 6
Overview of the Main Building and the Student Success Hub (SSH).

4. Campus Resources and Student Support ..... 7
Wellness services, career services, counseling, tutoring, and other student support offices.

5. Living in Fremont ..... 12
Housing options, opening a bank account, and transportation around the Bay Area.

6. Student Life and Involvement ..... 15
Clubs, activities, and ways to stay connected on campus.

7. Tips from Experience ..... 15
Practical advice for adjusting to university life at SFBU.

8. Quick Start Checklist ..... 17
Key steps to help you get started during your first weeks at SFBU.

9. Final Note ..... 18
Encouragement and reminders for making the most of your university experience.

# Welcome to San Francisco Bay University

If this is your first time at SFBU, this guide is for you. Starting university can be exciting, but it can also feel overwhelming, especially for students who are new to the U.S. education system, new to the Bay Area, or beginning university for the first time.

Many newcomers experience challenges during the transition. The academic system may be different, with new grading structures, semester schedules, and expectations from professors. At the same time, students may be adjusting to a new culture, new environment, and greater independence in managing their time, responsibilities, and studies.

This guide was created to help you navigate your first weeks at SFBU with more confidence. It introduces important campus spaces, student resources, and practical tips for settling into university life and living in Fremont and Silicon Valley.

Take a few minutes to read through it and use it as a starting point for your first months at SFBU.

# FIRST DAY AT SFBU

Yay! It's your first official day.




## STUDENT ORIENTATION

During orientation, you will get a tour of the school buildings with the OWLS (Student Orientation Week Leaders).
You will familiarize yourself with different campus places and resources, and there will be tables with important information from various staff members and departments.

### Important Orientation Questions

1 Billing and Finances

If you have questions about payments, the Bursar's Office will be available.
Edie Millet will be there to support students.

2 Counselors

Counselors for both graduate and undergraduate students will be available to answer questions.

3 IT Services

At the IT corner you will:

- Take photos for your student ID
- Set up your student accounts
- Get help accessing SFBU printers and systems

Student IDs are usually available for pickup at the front desk within one to two weeks.

4 Classes and Registration Support

For questions about course registration, Judy the Registrar will be available to help.

5 Student Clubs

You will also see information about clubs and student organizations you can join.

6 Orientation Booklet Stamps

You may receive stamps from different tables in your orientation booklet to confirm that you visited and learned about each service.

**Welcome BAYHAWK**
**Its Your first flight.**



# Undersanding The Campus

Great, you're done with orientation.
Now let's get you familiar with the campus.

## The Two Main SFBU Buildings

San Francisco Bay University has two main buildings that students interact with throughout the semester: the Main Building and the Student Success Hub (SSH). Knowing what each building offers can help you navigate campus more easily and find the support you need.

### The Main Building

The Main Building is where most students spend a large part of their day. Many classes take place here, especially in the classrooms located upstairs.





LRC

In The Main Building you'll find lots of interesting places like the LRC, Library, Teaching Faculty offices, computer lab and the game room

# Undersanding The Campus

## The Main Building

### Learning Resource Center (LRC)

The Learning Resource Center is the open space you see when you first enter the building. It is one of the most active areas on campus.
Students use this space to:

- Study or chill
- Meet classmates
- Work on group projects
- Attend school events

Many campus events and student gatherings take place here throughout the semester.
Because of its classrooms and shared spaces, the Main Building is where many students spend most of their time during the day.

### Library

A quiet place for studying, reading, and completing assignments.

### Computer Lab

Students can work on assignments, coding projects, or research using campus computers.

### Game Room

A space where students can relax, socialize, and take breaks between classes.

### Faculty Offices

Professors and teaching staff have offices here.
This is where you can attend office hours, ask questions, or get help with coursework.



# Undersanding The Campus

## SSH

While the Main Building focuses on classes and academic spaces, **the Student Success Hub (SSH)** is dedicated to student support services. This building brings together many offices and staff members who help YOU succeed academically, professionally, and personally.

Examples of offices / services in the SSH to know:

### 1. Student Wellness Services

Student Wellness Services hosts many workshops and events throughout the semester.
Examples include:

Weekly Wellness Workshops (Tuesdays)
Students meet weekly to learn about wellness topics through activities, discussions, and sometimes food.
**Activities can include:**

- Yoga
- Meditation and sound healing
- Zumba
- Pickleball




**Key staff include:**

- Beth Tsang — Licensed School Therapist
- Kell Fujimoto — Licensed School Therapist
- Margaux John — Disability and Accessibility Support

### 2. Career Services

Career Services helps students prepare for internships and future careers.
They offer:

- Career workshops
- Career fairs
- Resume support
- Help setting up Handshake and LinkedIn
- Internship support & Career Planning

## SSH

Director of Career Services: Kenrick Ali

### 3. Academic Counseling

Academic counselors help students plan their courses, manage academic challenges, and stay on track with their programs.
Rebecca — Academic Advising Counselor
Located in the Student Success Hub (SSH).

### 4. Academic Support Services

Students can receive one-on-one academic support.

**Language Support Specialist**- Leslie Ji

- Helps students with:
- Essays and writing
- Resumes
- LinkedIn profile optimization
- Speaking and communication skills



**Mathematics and Coding Support-** Evelyn
Provides tutoring and support for:

- Mathematics
- Coding
- Technical concepts

### 5. Student Support Assistants

Student assistants at the front desk of the SSH can help answer questions and guide you to the right resources.

- They can assist with:
- Resume help
- LinkedIn guidance
- Career questions
- Finding the right campus office

## 6. Food Pantry and Clothing Closet

SFBU also provides a Food Pantry and Clothing Closet to support students. Students can access:

- food supplies
- basic groceries
- professional clothing for interviews or career events

This resource is designed to help students who may need extra support while focusing on their studies.

## 7. Deans office:

The Dean of Student Services Office, led by Dean Kafele Khalfani, supports students with a variety of student related matters.
Students can reach out to the Dean's Office for:

- student concerns
- academic support guidance
- navigating campus policies
- student emergency services
- additional student resources
- Title IX and Equity



## Why The Student Success Hub Matters



If you ever need help academically, professionally, or personally, the Student Success Hub is one of the most important places on campus.

The services here are designed to support students throughout their time at SFBU.

Many offices also host workshops and campus events throughout the semester, so it is helpful to keep an eye on campus notice boards and student announcements for upcoming opportunities.

# LIVING IN FREMONT



# Living in Fremont

Adjusting to life outside the classroom is an important part of your university experience.
Fremont and the surrounding Bay Area offer many opportunities, but there are also practical things students should prepare for, such as housing, banking, and transportation.

## -Housing

Students at SFBU live in a variety of housing situations depending on their preferences and budget.
Some common options include:

- Student housing arranged through the university
- Shared apartments with roommates
- Living with family or relatives
- Apartments in nearby cities within commuting distance

If you are interested in student housing, you can contact the university housing team:
housing@sfbu.edu

### Helpful Tips for Housing

- Fremont housing can be expensive, so it is helpful to plan your budget early.
- Start looking for housing as early as possible, especially before the semester begins.
- Many students choose to share apartments with roommates to reduce living costs.
- When choosing housing, consider the distance to campus and available transportation.

# -Opening a Bank Account

Opening a bank account is an important step, especially for international students. A local bank account helps you manage daily expenses and makes it easier to handle financial responsibilities while studying.
Students usually open bank accounts to:

- Pay rent
- Receive payments or transfers
- Manage everyday expenses
- Use debit cards for purchases

There are several banks located around Fremont, including **Bank of America** and **Chase**.
Sometimes **SFBU invites local banks to campus** to help students open bank accounts directly at the university. These events can make the process easier and are often free for you.

### What to Bring

When opening a bank account, you may need:

- Passport
- Student ID
- Address information



# -Transportation

Getting around Fremont and the Bay Area is accessible through public transportation and other options.

## I. AC Transit Buses

SFBU provides students with a free transit pass for AC Transit buses. You can usually pick up their bus card from the front desk of the Main Building within about a week of starting at SFBU.
For more information, contact Michael Leinhos.

## II. BART (Bay Area Rapid Transit)

BART connects Fremont to other cities in the Bay Area, including Oakland and San Francisco.

## III. Rideshare Apps



Many students use rideshare services such as Uber or Lyft.

## IV. Walking Around Campus

The campus area itself is easy to walk around, and many student housing options may be within a reasonable distance of campus

# Tips From Experience

Starting university can feel overwhelming at first, but you'll discover that things become easier once they start asking questions, meeting people, and exploring the resources around them. Here I list some helpful tips to help you take advantage of there resourses and adjust quickly at SFBU

## 1. Ask for Help Early

Don't be afraid to ask questions when you are struggling with something. Whether it's an assignment, understanding a concept, or navigating campus, there are always people willing to help.
SFBU is a close-knit community, and students often find it easy to talk with classmates, professors, and staff.

## 2. Put Yourself Out There

One of the best ways to adjust to university life is by getting involved. SFBU has several clubs and organizations, including:

- Hiking Club
- Crochet Club
- Toastmasters Club
- IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers)
- Badminton Club
- International Students Club
- Entrepreneurship Club
- Research and Publication Club
- Art club
- Fashion Club
- Basketball and Soccer Clubs e.t.c.,

You can even create your own club, Like I did with the Badminton club.

# Tips From Experience

### 3. Stay Updated on Events and Opportunities

Throughout the semester, SFBU hosts many workshops, career events, and student activities.
To stay updated:

- Check campus notice boards
- Join the SGA (Student Government Association) What's app group chat for updates
- Follow SFBU social media pages (Instagram, YouTube, WhatsApp channels)

### 4. Connect With Your Professors and Classmates

Because SFBU classes are relatively small, it is easier to build relationships with professors and classmates.
Try to:

- Ask questions during class
- Attend professor office hours
- Study with classmates
- Participate in discussions

### 5. Give Yourself Time to Adjust

Starting university is a big transition.
Be patient with yourself, stay curious, and remember that everyone is learning along the way. It all starts by being open to new experiences, explore yor environments, and having a growth mindset.



# QUICK START CHECKLIST

## Before Classes Start

- Attend orientation
- Set up your SFBU email and student accounts
- Pick up your student ID / badge card
- Activate Canvas and review your course schedule
- Read your course syllabus

## First Week On Campus

- Introduce yourself to classmates and professors
- Locate the library, computer lab, and LRC
- Visit the Student Success Hub
- Explore campus resources and ask questions

## First Month at SFBU

- Meet with an academic counselor or advisor
- Visit Career Services to explore internships
- Set up Handshake and LinkedIn
- Attend workshops, wellness events, and campus activities
- Use tutoring or academic support services if needed

## FINAL NOTE

University is the start of a new chapter. Take your time getting familiar with your environment, connect with people around you, and make use of the many resources available at SFBU.

With the right support and a willingness to explore, your first semester can become a strong foundation for the rest of your university journey.